

Figure 1: Features

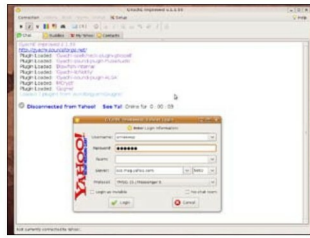


Figure 3: Login screen

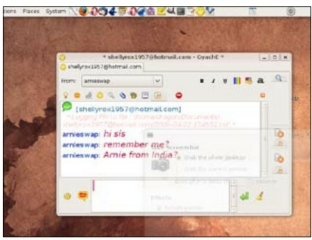


Figure 2: Chat window

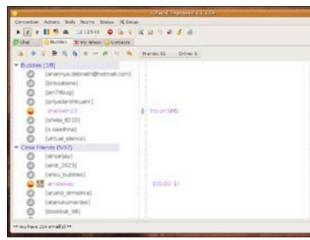


Figure 4: Contact list

because it can always be forked.

Now, enough history and politics. Coming back to GYachI—this IM client offers some cool features that are all missing in Pidgin and Kopete, which most of us use to talk to our Yahoo buddies. I wonder why the Pidgin and Kopete guys shy away from sharing photos... ;-)

F(re)eatures

GYachI attracted me because it enabled me to do almost everything that any Yahoo user can do on a sluggish Windows machine or the too prudish Mac machines. However, since you run it on GNU/Linux systems, no one can send 'malicious' software and corrupt your system.

In the world of GYachI, no one can boot you, or force you to shut down the IM client. This application will automatically term users as booters if they try to mess with you and throw them in the ignore list.

What's more? You can share photos just the way you do on Yahoo! Well, to be honest, it's not the way you do it on Yahoo!, as people often complain there, "Hey I can't see your photo in *Share*..." and you don't even know what's wrong. In GYachI, you can see how many of your photos have been downloaded on your friend's machine. You can share files by sending them, you can use video chat if you have a Web cam, and hey, it even lets you record the stream. Hmm, now this *is* something cool.

GYachI is an awesome alternative to YM on GNU/Linux machines, but this project needs some dynamic development—the last major release came out back in November 2007. As users, we can apply the simple rule of development—more users will create more of a buzz to attract the attention of the developers to get back to their jobs ;-) So, give GYachI a try—if it's not available in your distro's software repository, go to *tinyurl.com/gyachi* to get a DEB or RPM file of your choice. And if you like it, simply do what I did—spread the word.

By: Swapnil Bhartiya

A Free Software fund-a-mental-ist and Charles Bukowski fan, Swapnil also writes fiction and tries to find cracks in a proprietary company's 'paper armours'. He is a big movie buff and prefers listening to music at such loud volumes that he's gone partially deaf when it comes to identifying anything positive about proprietary companies. Oh, and he is also the assistant editor of *EFYTimes.com*.